

Rep. Tom Emmer on Wall Street

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CHERYL:

Here to weigh in on all of it, House Majority Whip, Minnesota Congressman Tom Emmer. Sir, it's great to have you here. What is your take on the president's approach to Xi Jinping? What do you think that these talks actually delivered for America?

REP. TOM EMMER:

When you talk about this meeting, it's pretty hollow when you hear Democrats on the Hill who just don't like anything that President Trump is doing. How do you resolve conflicts? You resolve them by talking. These are two incredibly powerful leaders representing countries with completely different business models, right? President Xi has a top-down business model. He's in control of everything. And President Trump has a bottom-up. Look, the United States, the world is a safer place when the United States is strong. And Donald Trump, it's good when we have him in the White House because he is talking to President Xi, letting him know how serious these things are, trying to resolve this. This is the best negotiator in America, the best negotiator in the world. He's already made huge progress with the Chinese leader. I think you're going to see even more come out of this summit.

CHERYL:

What do you think that that's going to be on the trade front? Do you think it is the Taiwan front? Because certainly Xi Jinping was hoping that he could come here and convince President Trump to say that Taiwan should not be an independent nation.

REP. TOM EMMER:

I don't think that's going to happen. That stance of our nation has been in place for decades. But at the same time, Xi Jinping had his list of asks. Absolutely. And I'm sure there are some that are going to remain in place, whether it be Taiwan, whether it's AI. I think they're probably discussing artificial intelligence and how they might put some guardrails on that. I have no doubt, Cheryl, that they are talking about the the Chinese support of the evil regime in Iran. And I again, I think that we have things that China needs. China wants to be able to provide things to America. That's the biggest lever that our president has. And he's not going to give up anything. This is the beauty of negotiation. I think historically his predecessors think negotiation is you start at 10 and you end up at negative 10. Donald Trump starts at 10 and he moves towards 10 no matter what. So he knows how to negotiate. And I think when this is done, you can't reach agreements without sitting down face to face. That's my opinion. And we have a president that's better at doing it than anybody else. And a lot of there were a lot of preliminary talks between before the two leaders actually met face to face. And that happens a lot of times in these situations.

CHERYL:

All right. Let's talk about AI. The administration did propose an AI safety notification system with China. This is a Cold War era hotline. If AI gets out of control, Xi urged the U.S. to cooperate on AI. President Trump said there's going to be no moves towards joint regulations. He said, quote, our guardrail is the DOJ. So Congressman, you sit on the House Digital Assets and AI Subcommittee. I want to get your take on this. Is the DOJ the right body to oversee where we go with AI and the guardrails? Or should it be more of a commission? Maybe that is an independent commission within the government that is industry leaders, experts, those that maybe know the technology better than those at the DOJ.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, everybody's an expert, Cheryl. I just another commission is not the answer. Another government entity is not the answer. I think what we're doing a disservice of, we're talking about the Department of Justice. But what that really means is we already have laws in place in this country that if you are building something, if you are providing a service, you have to do so in the most responsible manner. And if someone is harmed, be it physical, be it economic, otherwise, we have laws that have the ability to be compensated. This doesn't happen in China. I think the president has made this very clear. There will not be joint regulation. And why? Because we innovate in this country. Our business model allows people who are entrepreneurial to start new projects. It's why we're always ahead. The Chinese wish that they could be as innovative as the Americans. The president's not going to take that away. I can also add, I've been part of the Digital Assets Committee ever since it was created in the House Financial Services Committee. Because Cheryl, I've been involved with the digital assets space. That's cryptocurrencies, that's tokens, that's all kinds of different things since I came to Congress. And it's taken 10 years to build a very thoughtful framework on how you deal with that. We should have the same thoughtful approach when it comes to artificial intelligence. And also making sure that we have a thoughtful approach that China is still, in many ways, an enemy to the United States. And that was written about in the journal with AI and even Taiwan, AI and the growing threat to Tehran, China's drive to dominate the technology and the island nation, biggest threat that humanity faces.

CHERYL:

But I want to move on beyond AI with you, because another major national security concern is China's support for Iran. House Foreign Affairs Chairman Brian Mast is arguing on FoxNews.com that Beijing is quote one of the biggest culprits in Americans' current struggle with the high cost of living, particularly at the gas pump, by arming Iran, whose conflict with the U.S. is wreaking havoc on global trade. This is not just about gas prices. Diesel's been hitting record highs. That means higher costs for truckers, farmers, businesses all across the country. And all of these prices are rising right before the midterms. Your thoughts?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, we have 39 days till one of the most important midterms in our history. And people don't seem to want to acknowledge that America's enemies, be it China, be it and let's call them adversaries, America's adversaries, China, Russia, the the Ayatollahs and the IRGC in Iran. They prefer a weak Donald Trump. They would not. They would love to see Donald Trump have to deal with impeachments every week with Democrats in the House. So they're trying to. And I agree with Brian Mast. It is in their best interest to make sure that the that the United States feels this this gas price issue, because you're already moving tankers out of the Hormuz Strait. There was a report not last week, I think, in The Wall Street Journal that there aren't enough tankers to move what they have. So why isn't the price coming down? Well, you might want to ask our adversaries. And the fact that China is supporting the IRGC and the Ayatollahs is completely unacceptable, which is why I have no doubt this was one of the main topics that our president discussed with President Xi in their meeting.

CHERYL:

Hopefully so. To tell China to quit arming and helping out the Iranians, who, by the way, their goal is to, you know, kill American personnel and service members in the Middle East. Congressman Tom Emmer, it's great to see you, sir. Thank you for being with me.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Thank you, Cheryl.

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